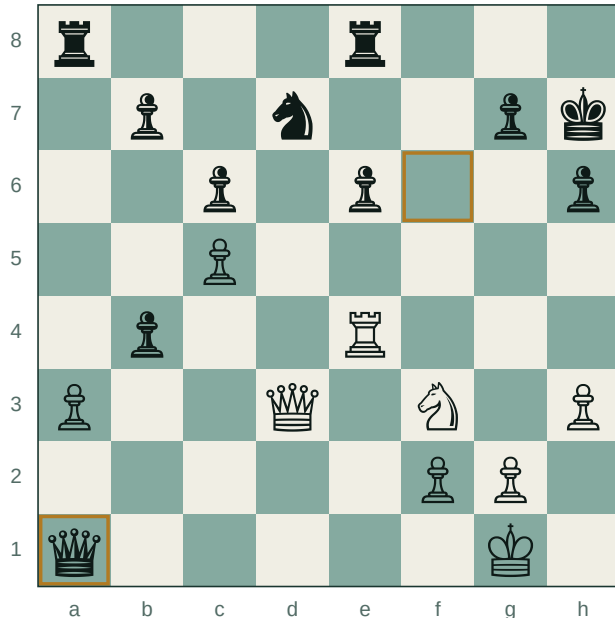


Discovered checks: White, move 25

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 24...Qxa1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Re1+ Kh8 26. Rxa1

25.Re1+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on d3 attacks the king on h7. Recorded reply: **25...Kh8**.

26.Rxa1 The rook captures the queen on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -6 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: knight on d7 and queen on a1. Check for tactical protection.